

Cherry — DealFlow Business Strategy

Business model, market approach, revenue strategy and company direction

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1. Executive Business Definition

Cherry intends to build a product-led software company supported by optional managed services. The first focused product is DealFlow, a real-estate business operating platform.

DealFlow is not positioned as a generic CRM or property marketplace. Its purpose is to help real-estate businesses organize existing and new business data and operate the complete opportunity lifecycle from lead through closure.

Core promise

Manage every real-estate opportunity from first contact to closure, without losing history, follow-ups, documents, ownership, or the next action.

2. Customer Problem

Real-estate businesses commonly operate across spreadsheets, phone contacts, messaging applications, property portals, notebooks, documents and informal processes.

This fragmentation creates missed follow-ups, stale leads, poor visibility, duplicate data, weak property matching, incomplete documentation and unclear ownership of work.

DealFlow addresses the operational problem rather than simply providing another database.

3. Target Market

Primary entry segment: individual agents, small brokers, small agencies, property consultants and channel partners.

Expansion segments: builders/developers, larger sales teams, multi-branch agencies and organizations with more complex workflows.

The product should share one core model while adapting workflows, permissions and screens to the customer's operating model.

4. Business Model

Primary revenue: recurring SaaS subscriptions.

Potential secondary revenue: onboarding, data migration, managed operations, premium AI usage, messaging/storage/integration charges and enterprise capabilities.

Managed services are optional and commercially separate from the product. They can be offered when a customer has valuable existing data but lacks internal capacity to organize or maintain it.

Product revenue

- Monthly or annual subscriptions
- Additional users/teams where appropriate
- Premium automation, AI, storage or integrations where economically justified
- Higher-tier capabilities for larger organizations

Managed-service revenue

- Data cleanup and migration
- Business data administration

- CRM/DealFlow operations support
- Reporting and operational assistance

5. Service-to-Product Relationship

Cherry should never make the product dependent on manual service work. The product must remain independently usable.

If managed services are sold, repeated manual activities should be studied and progressively converted into product capabilities, automation or AI.

This creates a productization loop: customer problem → service observation → standardization → automation → product feature → scalable SaaS capability.

6. Commercial Strategy

Sell the outcome, not the number of screens. The commercial conversation should focus on missed opportunities, follow-up discipline, operational visibility, data organization and deal execution.

Initial validation should prioritize a small number of paying customers rather than broad feature development.

Pricing should be validated through actual willingness to pay rather than treated as fixed before market evidence.

7. Business Metrics

Acquisition: qualified prospects, trials/demos, conversion to paid.

Activation: successful data import, first lead managed, first follow-up completed, first property match.

Engagement: active users, follow-ups completed, site visits managed, workflows completed.

Business value: lead response time, follow-up completion, site-visit conversion, negotiation progression, deals influenced.

Retention: renewal, churn, expansion, active accounts.

Service economics: onboarding effort, support effort, recurring service margin, conversion from service-assisted onboarding to product-led usage.

8. Business Risks and Controls

Feature sprawl → maintain a clear product boundary and evidence-based roadmap.

Over-customization → use configuration and reusable workflows instead of customer-specific code.

Low adoption → optimize the core daily workflow and reduce data-entry burden.

AI errors → constrain AI to approved data, permissions and business policies.

Data/security risk → tenant isolation, access control, auditability, backups and controlled migrations.

Weak product-market fit → launch early with a narrow customer segment and measure actual business outcomes.

9. Long-Term Company Direction

DealFlow is a first product and a commercial learning platform, not the final destination for Cherry.

Cherry can later build additional focused products using the same company-level product discipline.

Onera remains a separate long-term vision for a broader business operating platform. DealFlow should not be prematurely transformed into Onera; lessons and proven patterns can inform Onera later.

10. Business Principles

Build for real customer problems.

Charge for measurable business value.

Start narrow and expand through evidence.

Keep the product simple for customers and sophisticated internally.

Treat customer data as a valuable asset.

Use services as an optional revenue stream, not as a substitute for product quality.

Build a company capable of repeatedly creating, operating and improving products.